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Chemicals | North America

China Reinstates Urea Export Price Floors

Trade sources are now reporting that China has reinstated urea export price floors for shipments to India at no less than \$500 mt FOB for large granular and \$510 mt FOB for auto-grade. Export floors for other destinations may be "appropriately reduced" but those these exact levels remain under discussion, though we expect definition in the near term and for now assume floors similar to Indian levels. Exporters who sell below these levels may lose the self-regulatory enterprise status.

The reintroduction of floors comes as the latest India tender for ~1.7mm mt reportedly saw offers as low as \$410s/t CFR which would net back to below \$400/t FOB for Chinese exporters. Given the now \$500 mt floor, the signal seems to be that China will not be participating in this India tender.

This reinstatement supports our view that there was risk that China would look to limit export volume but max price while the SOH remains closed (see [LINK](#)). How much these new floors will impact global market prices bears watching over the balance of the week given the recent significant declines in global prices: US NoLa prices had moved to a \$360 st to \$410 st range as of yesterday (though we note Chinese exports have not been in the US for many years), Brazil moved down \$55 mt to \$530-\$540 mt CFR last week while Iran dropped \$100 mt to \$620-\$630 mt FOB,

Likewise, we also note that SABIC indicated yesterday ([LINK](#)) that it exported its first urea bulk shipment in May, reaching 40% of daily production transferred from Jubail to Yanbu. SABIC continues to ramp up and is looking to utilize additional ports. Management have targeted to reach 70% of daily production transferred via alternative routes going forward while also indicating that all plants are operating at maximum capacity, and management expects this to continue.

We believe that China has been selective with both urea and DAP/MAP exports in recent years given potential (and now real) supply disruptions from various geopolitical conflicts (first Russia/Ukraine and now Iran). This has created local oversupply, which in turn has provided extremely low prices for Chinese farmers, but limited profits and cash flows for local Chinese fertilizer companies. Price floors could limit exports versus the 3mm mt quota but max cash flow for producers while strategically keeping higher inventory in country.

There has been some concern in the markets that China would remain guarded with urea exports until the Strait of Hormuz has reopened and it is possible the institution of price floors is related to this. However, the price floors are now lower and the SOH remains closed at present.

As always, Chinese fertilizer export policy is subject to change, so we will stay closely tuned here. The next important development for markets is whether

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CHEMICALS

North America

Industry View

In-Line

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Chinese MAP/DAP exports resume in August. Given continued dislocations in sulfur markets - and not just SOH related (i.e., Russia further reducing exports in recent weeks), we believe resumption of exports in August is harder to call at present and likely much more reliant on improvement in both sulfur availability and costs.

China initially put urea exports price floors at \$660 mt FOB (prilled) and \$670 mt FOB (granular), with a separate floor of \$680 mt FOB for any prills sold to India. The initial removal of price floors yesterday was ahead of the close of the recent India tender.

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Overweight/Buy	1542	42%	465	51%	30%	707	43%
Equal-weight/Hold	1571	43%	369	40%	23%	723	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	0	0%	0%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	551	15%	86	9%	16%	201	12%
Total	3,667		920			1632	

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ICL Group Ltd (ICL.N)	E (01/05/2024)	\$5.59
International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF.N)	O (11/11/2024)	\$72.60
Steven K Haynes, CFA		
Ashland Inc. (ASH.N)	E (09/08/2025)	\$57.46
Vincent Andrews		
Air Products and Chemicals Inc. (APD.N)	E (05/29/2025)	\$276.77
Albemarle Corporation (ALB.N)	E (12/15/2025)	\$149.84
Avient Corporation (AVNT.N)	E (12/14/2020)	\$34.49
Axalta Coating Systems Ltd (AXTA.N)	++	\$31.84
Celanese Corp. (CE.N)	E (01/20/2026)	\$49.08
CF Industries (CF.N)	E (05/25/2016)	\$109.45
Chemours Co (CC.N)	E (01/30/2018)	\$20.86
Corteva Inc. (CTVA.N)	O (12/14/2020)	\$75.86
Dow Inc. (DOW.N)	E (12/01/2019)	\$34.20
DuPont De Nemours Inc. (DD.N)	E (05/26/2021)	\$46.99
Eastman Chemical Co (EMN.N)	O (01/17/2019)	\$71.67
Ecolab Inc. (ECL.N)	O (01/28/2025)	\$257.41
FMC Corporation (FMC.N)	E (10/24/2023)	\$11.10
Huntsman Corp (HUN.N)	E (12/11/2023)	\$14.23
Intrepid Potash (IPI.N)	U (10/03/2013)	\$34.67
Linde PLC (LIN.O)	O (02/09/2020)	\$501.92
LyondellBasell Industries N.V. (LYB.N)	O (12/01/2019)	\$64.43

Mosaic Company (MOS.N)	E (03/16/2016)	\$21.38
Nutrien Ltd (NTR.N)	O (01/14/2026)	\$67.28
Olin Corp. (OLN.N)	U (01/10/2023)	\$24.28
PPG Industries Inc. (PPG.N)	E (11/01/2019)	\$112.88
RPM International Inc. (RPM.N)	E (12/14/2020)	\$104.61
Sherwin-Williams Co. (SHW.N)	O (03/19/2014)	\$299.55
Tronox Holdings Plc-Class A (TROX.N)	E (01/30/2018)	\$7.30
Westlake Corp (WLK.N)	E (01/09/2018)	\$85.26

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.

* Historical prices are not split adjusted.